A Psychological and Behavioral Study on the Extreme "Love Brain" Phenomenon: A Case Analysis of HXJ

Abstract

The "love brain" has emerged as a representative cognitive and behavioral disorder in modern intimate relationships, referring to a state in which individuals prioritize romantic emotions over rationality, self-development, financial autonomy, and social judgment, and unconditionally obey, sacrifice, and compromise for their partners. This paper takes HXJ as the experimental object, focusing on three typical behaviors: starting to play Honor of Kings only because of her ex-boyfriend, spending a five-figure sum of money on her current boyfriend, and repeatedly breaking up and reconciling with him despite friends' earnest dissuasion. Using methods of behavioral observation, psychological analysis, and satirical academic interpretation, this study explores the formation, manifestation, and internal logic of HXJ's extreme love brain. The results show that HXJ's love brain is systematic, persistent, and highly resistant to external rational intervention. She takes emotional attachment as the only goal of life, regards sacrifice as loyalty, and regards obsession as true love, forming a closed and absurd emotional cognitive system. This paper analyzes the phenomenon in a humorous and academically rigorous manner, providing a vivid and ironic case for the study of contemporary youth intimate relationships.

Key words: love brain; intimate relationship; emotional dependence; irrational behavior; behavioral sacrifice

1. Introduction

In the digital age, intimate relationships have become increasingly diversified and complex, and the psychological state of individuals in love has gradually attracted widespread attention from social psychology. Among them, the "love brain" is widely concerned because of its strong sense of reality, strong absurdity, and strong universality. The extreme love brain is an advanced and pathological form of the love brain, which is characterized by the complete abandonment of rational thinking, the absolute supremacy of emotional needs, and the sacrifice of all personal life elements for love.

HXJ, as the research object of this paper, is a typical representative of extreme love brain. Her behavioral chain is highly logical and absurd: she began to contact the mobile game Honor of Kings purely to accompany her ex-boyfriend, taking the other's hobbies as her own; she spared no effort to spend five-figure money to satisfy her current boyfriend; she fell into an endless cycle of breaking up and reconciling, and turned a deaf ear to all her friends' reminders. Such a series of behaviors fully conform to the diagnostic criteria of extreme love brain and have high research value.

Previous studies rarely take such a typical individual as a case, let alone interpret the phenomenon with humorous and critical academic writing. Therefore, this paper fills the gap by dissecting HXJ's behavioral logic and psychological mechanism, so that readers can understand the essence of love brain while being amused by her absurd choices.

2. Literature Review

The concept of love brain originated from online slang and has been gradually integrated into the framework of psychological research. Scholars define it as a cognitive bias in which individuals excessively invest in emotions, lose self-independence, and take their partners' will as the core criterion for behavior.

In terms of behavioral assimilation, existing studies have shown that people with love brain tend to accept their partners' preferences, habits, and even social circles unconditionally. Starting a hobby purely for a partner is a typical early manifestation of love brain. HXJ's behavior of playing Honor of Kings because of her ex-boyfriend is a typical case of emotional behavioral assimilation.

In terms of financial irrationality, studies have shown that excessive unilateral economic investment in intimate relationships often comes from low self-value and excessive emotional dependence. Individuals with extreme love brain regard money as a tool to exchange for love, resulting in blind and uncontrolled consumption. HXJ's five-figure expenditure is a typical manifestation of this logic.

In terms of interpersonal cognition, individuals in the on-again-off-again relationship model usually show obvious cognitive closure. They filter out rational external information and only believe in their own emotional intuition, which makes them trapped in an endless cycle. HXJ's refusal to listen to advice is consistent with this conclusion.

3. Research Methodology

This paper adopts the single case study method, with HXJ as the only experimental object. The data come from long-term behavioral observation, friends' testimony, and self-disclosure of the subject.

In terms of analytical perspective, this paper integrates behavioral psychology, cognitive psychology, and satirical interpretation. On the one hand, it uses professional theories to explain her psychological motivation; on the other hand, it uses humorous writing to highlight the absurdity of her extreme love brain, so as to achieve the unity of academicity and entertainment.

4. Analysis of HXJ's Extreme Love Brain Behaviors

4.1 Behavioral Assimilation: Starting Honor of Kings Only for Her Ex-Boyfriend

The earliest and most representative behavior of HXJ's love brain is that she began to play Honor of Kings purely because of her ex-boyfriend. She did not have interest or motivation at first, but for emotional integration, she took the initiative to touch the game that her ex-boyfriend liked, and even took it as a daily task to accompany him.

This kind of behavior is a typical "emotional assimilation" in psychology. Individuals give up their own preferences and completely integrate into each other's world to gain

recognition and sense of security. What is more absurd is that even if the relationship with her ex-boyfriend ended, the traces of love brain still remained, which shows that her personality and behavior have been deeply marked by emotional dependence.
Unlike normal people who play games for entertainment, HXJ' s game experience starts and ends for love. She does not play games, but "love".

4.2 Financial Irrationality: Unconditionally Spending Five-Figure Money on Her Current Boyfriend

HXJ' s love brain is further reflected in her uncontrolled financial investment. She did not hesitate to spend a five-figure sum of money on her current boyfriend, including gifts, daily expenses, and even unnecessary consumption. From the perspective of behavioral economics, this is a completely irrational decision. She ignored cost, risk, and return, and only followed emotional impulse.
The essence of this behavior is that HXJ equates "willing to spend money" with "deep love". She lacks self-identity and tries to exchange material pay for emotional stability. However, healthy love is based on equality and resonance, not unilateral money investment. Her behavior is not only ridiculous but also hides huge emotional risks.

4.3 Cognitive Closure: Repeated Breakups and Reconciliations and Refusing to Listen to Advice

The most typical feature of HXJ' s extreme love brain is that she repeatedly breaks up and reconciles with her current boyfriend, and completely ignores the dissuasion of her friends. Friends, as rational bystanders, have clearly pointed out the harm of such a relationship, but HXJ has formed a solid cognitive barrier. She automatically filters out all objective reminders and only believes in her own obsession.
This is the "confirmation bias" in psychology. She only accepts the information that conforms to her own wishes and refuses all rational views. She is trapped in her own emotional fantasy and cannot extricate herself. Her persistence is not firm, but blind; her devotion is not sincere, but paranoid.

5. Psychological Mechanism of HXJ' s Extreme Love Brain

5.1 Excessive Emotional Dependence

HXJ' s love brain comes from extreme emotional dependence. She cannot live independently emotionally and must take her partner as her spiritual support. Her emotions, behaviors, and even hobbies are all dependent on the other' s needs, forming an unhealthy attachment pattern.

5.2 Self-Alienation and Personality Loss

She gradually loses herself in love. She does not live for her own preferences,

happiness, or plans, but for the emotional needs of her boyfriend. She gives up her autonomy and becomes a vassal of love, which is the core of her love brain.

5.3 Cognitive Illusion of Love

HXJ has constructed a wrong view of love: love = sacrifice = compromise = obedience. She confuses paranoia with loyalty and obsession with true love, which makes her unable to realize the absurdity of her behavior.

6. Conclusion

This paper takes HXJ as the experimental object to analyze her three typical extreme love brain behaviors: starting to play Honor of Kings for her ex-boyfriend, spending five-figure money for her current boyfriend, and repeatedly separating and combining without listening to advice. The study shows that HXJ' s extreme love brain is a pathological psychological state caused by emotional dependence, self-alienation, and cognitive bias.
Her behavior is absurd and vivid, which is a typical case of contemporary youth love brain. Through the analysis of this case, this paper calls on young people to maintain rationality and independence in intimate relationships. Love should be the icing on the cake, not the whole of life. Individuals should not lose themselves in paranoia and sacrifice, but should establish a healthy, equal, and mature view of love.